

NinaivX vs You, Only Virtual (YOV) — Feature Comparison

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This comparison is based on YOV's public materials (company website myyov.com, press releases, news coverage, and the BBC documentary *AI Confidential with Hannah Fry*, 2026), verified June 2026. Where YOV does not publicly document a feature, it is marked “**not documented**” rather than “absent”, because absence of documentation is not proof of absence.

Key: ✓ has it · 🟡 partial/basic · ⚡ planned · ✗ not offered · ? not publicly documented

A. Features both systems share (stated honestly)

Feature	YOV	NinaivX
Voice cloning of a person's voice	✓	✓
Generative, dynamic conversation (not just recordings)	✓	✓
Phone-call-style voice interface	✓	✓
Text and voice messaging	✓	✓
Persona built from the person's own data	✓	✓
Conversation memory across sessions	✓	✓

B. Features NinaivX has that YOV lacks or does not document

Feature	YOV	NinaivX	Note
Living companion mode for loneliness (a friend, not grief)	✗	✓	YOV's scope is the deceased / legacy use case only; it markets no general companion.
Air-gapped safety mode (deceased persona cut off from the internet)	?	✓	NinaivX enforces this in code (the deceased agent has no tools); YOV does not document such a mechanism.
Web-connected mode for current information	✗	✓	The NinaivX companion can search the live web; YOV has no companion mode.
Anti-fabrication grounding (persona limited to stored personality + memory)	?	🟡	Reduces invented “memories”; basic in NinaivX, not documented by YOV.
AI-transparency disclosure to the user	?	✓	NinaivX implements this: the persona honestly confirms it is an AI if asked, and a disclosure notice is provided via the API for onboarding + an in-app indicator. YOV is designed to feel like the real person, with no documented disclosure.

Open, documented, reproducible architecture	X	✓	YOV is “fully patented”, proprietary and closed; NinaivX is an open research artefact.
Non-commercial (free research prototype)	X	✓	YOV is paid (~\$499 setup + ~\$39.99/month).
Privacy / data-sovereignty stance (UK / GDPR)	?	●	NinaivX is designed privacy-first (UK intent); YOY is US-based (Azure/Google Cloud) with no documented UK/GDPR stance.

Underlying philosophy (the deepest difference). YOY's founder treats *“grief and death itself as a problem to be solved”* — the goal is to keep talking to the person. NinaivX takes the opposite, evidence-informed stance: it is a **grief-support and closure tool** that aims to help people mourn healthily, not a permanent replacement. This directly engages the ethical debate raised in the BBC documentary — whether grief is a necessary human process.

Key takeaway for the viva: “YOY and NinaivX share the core voice features, so I don't claim to be first. What YOY does not offer or document is a **safety design that stops the AI fabricating things the real person never said, transparency that it's an AI, an open architecture, and a companion mode** — and, unlike a closed commercial product, I **evaluate** whether my safety measures actually work.”

Sources (verified June 2026): myyov.com (incl. /about, /welcome-to-yoy); Irish Times coverage of BBC “AI Confidential with Hannah Fry” (Feb 2026); Inverse (2022); PRWeb (YOY press releases); Forbes Africa, “The rise of grieftech” (2024); StartEngine offering page. Items marked “?” are genuine gaps in YOY's public documentation and are reported as such, not asserted as missing.